

KEEP THIS ONE; IT'S BUILT TO LIVE INSIDE YOUR GRADEBOOK

AI & Academic Integrity: Setting Clear Expectations with Students

THE STANCE

Clarity beats policing. Name the lane on every assignment.
And no accusation ever rests on a detector score alone.

The three lanes

Lane	What it means	The one-line label
1 · AI-free	The point is your own thinking, from scratch.	"AI-free. This one is all you; I need to see your own thinking to teach you well."
2 · AI-assisted	Brainstorm, feedback, and polish allowed; the thinking stays yours; use is disclosed.	"AI-assisted. Brainstorming and feedback are fine; write the final yourself and note what you used."
3 · AI-included	Using AI well is part of the task; judgment is what's graded.	"AI-included. Use the tool; show your prompts; your judgment is what's being graded."

Parts can differ: "research lane 3, final draft lane 1" is a perfectly good answer. Name a lane per part and print it on the assignment.

One system, two boxes (both are school-wide templates)

The AI Box is the teacher's half: it prints on the assignment. The Disclosure block is the student's half: it sits at the end of the work. **Both are fixed templates, identical in every classroom**, so honesty is the same size for everyone and "what's allowed?" has one answer building-wide. Copy them exactly; change only the bracketed parts.

Template 1 · The AI Box (prints on the assignment)

AI BOX · [assignment name]

Lane: ☐ 1 AI-free ☐ 2 AI-assisted ☐ 3 AI-included (parts in different lanes? name a lane per part)

Okay: [what's allowed, in student words]

Not okay: [what's not, in student words]

Disclosure: fill in the AI Disclosure block at the end of your work. Every time.

If something seems off: I'll ask you to walk me through your work. That's a conversation, not an accusation.

Template 2 · The AI Disclosure block (end of the student's work)

AI DISCLOSURE (check all that apply)

- ☐ No AI used
- ☐ AI helped me brainstorm or outline
- ☐ AI gave me feedback on a draft
- ☐ AI drafted text that I revised

Tool I used: _____

What I asked it to do: _____

Why checkboxes instead of "write two honest sentences": ask thirty students for sentences and you get thirty different things. Checkboxes take ten seconds to fill, ten seconds to read, and look identical from room to room.

The soft-landing rule: if a student checked the boxes, the conversation is coaching, not consequences. Punish disclosure once and you've taught the whole class to hide.

Four assignment upgrades (one is usually enough)

- **Make thinking visible:** collect the outline, the draft, the version history; grade the journey.
- **Anchor it locally:** tie the task to what happened in your room; a chatbot was never in your class.
- **Move some thinking live:** a two-minute "defend your choice," an in-class quick-write; normal, not gotcha.
- **Assess the process:** where AI is allowed, grade the prompts, the disclosure, and a short accept/reject reflection.

The conversation, scripted

Move	Say
Open with curiosity	"Walk me through how you made this. What did you start with? What was the hardest part?"

Get specific	"Tell me more about this paragraph. What does this word mean here?"
Gather process evidence	Can they explain their choices? Is there a draft? Does in-class writing match?
Land it	First offense under a new expectation: teach the lane, reset, move on. Pattern: follow your school's process, with the process evidence in hand.

The never list: never open with "did you use AI?" · never accuse on a detector score alone (OpenAI shut down its own detector for low accuracy; commercial detectors flagged over half of real essays by non-native English speakers as AI) · never make it public · never forget most students were never told the rule.

Why clarity is the whole game

- **Use is normal:** 54% of teens use AI for schoolwork (Pew, 2026); guidance lags adoption (RAND, 2025).
- **The rate didn't spike:** self-reported cheating held at 60–70% before and after ChatGPT (Lee, Pope et al., 2024). The problem is older than the bot.
- **Why kids cheat:** pressure, disengagement, feeling disrespected; rarely tool access (Stanford GSE).
- **What integrity protects:** honesty, trust, fairness, respect, responsibility, courage (ICAI).

My two sentences for the hard moment (draft them here)

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